

75 Quantity

In English there are many ways to express general or specific quantities, say whether quantities are adequate, and compare different quantities.

See also:

Singular and plural nouns 69

Countable and uncountable nouns 70

75.1 USING QUANTITY PHRASES

English has different phrases for quantities when the exact number is not known.

"Some" is used when there are more than one, but the exact quantity is unknown.

There are **some** buildings.



"A few" is used for small numbers.

There are **a few** buildings.



"Lots of" is used for large numbers.

There are **lots of** buildings.



FURTHER EXAMPLES

There are **some** very old trees in my local park.



There are **a few** items on the menu that I'd like to try.



There are **a few** sights that I'd like to see while I'm here.



There are **lots of** mountains in the Alps that I'd love to climb.



There are **some** vegetables that I really don't like.



There are **a few** cars parked outside my house.



Lots of my friends rely on trains to get to work.



There are **lots of** people waiting outside the gallery.

